

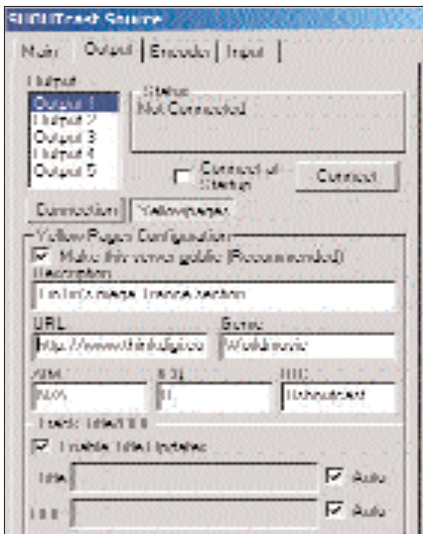
window with four buttons. The one placed at the top of the window displays your machine's current IP. The remaining three buttons adorn the bottom portion of the window. The second of these buttons is meant for configuring the streaming server—the configuration options are pretty simple except for the redirection entry. This allows you to use the music coming from another server as the source for your own server. Perhaps you could share the music from your favourite Internet radio station with some of your friends. Just enter the address of that server in the URL redirection box. The last button is used to 'Start' and 'Stop' the stream of music being broadcast from your streaming server.

Setting the source

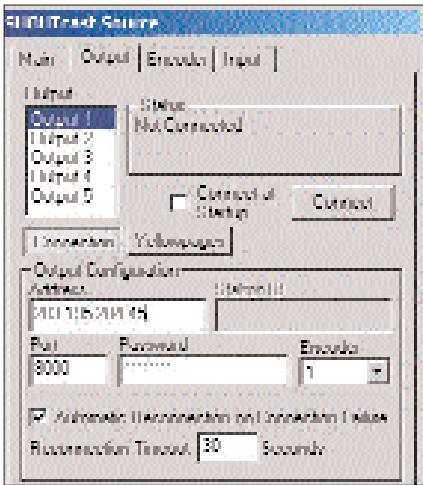
Before you can actually use Simple Server:Shout as your streaming server you need to provide it with the music stream. You can use Winamp as your own source by installing a SHOUTcast DSP Plug-in for Winamp which can serve music to the Distributed Network Access System (DNAS). This can be found at [www.shoutcast.com](http://www.shoutcast.com) download section. The installation will create a new entry in your DSP plug-ins list in Winamp.

You are now ready to stream your music. Open Winamp and press [Ctrl] + [P] to open up preferences and navigate to DSP/Effects under the plug-ins category. You will see SHOUTcast source for Winamp in the right-hand-side pane. This confirms that your installation was OK. Choose the plug-in by clicking on it.

This opens the plug-in window in which you can make the required configuration changes. The Main tab shows you



SHOUTcast DSP plug-in for Winamp



Specify your server connection details

the total duration for which each output was active. This tab also displays the sound input levels from your Winamp.

The Output tab is the one in which the server connection details are specified. Click on 'Output1' from the Output list. Check that the 'Connection' button is pressed. Enter the IP of your machine as shown on SimpleServer:Shout (if you are a DSL/cable user, enter the static IP provided by your ISP). Leave the port at its default setting of 8000. Enter the same password as in the configuration section of the streaming server. Select 1 from the 'Encoder' drop-down menu. Here you can also set the 'reconnection timeouts' in case of a connection failure.

The 'Yellow pages' is useful if you want your server to be listed at various audio streaming index sites. Check the 'Make this server public' box. This ensures that your server will be listed in those music sites whenever your server becomes active.

In the 'Encoder' tab, choose 'MP3 encoder' from the 'Encoder type' drop-down list and from the 'Encoder settings' drop-down list, choose the speed at which you would prefer to relay your MP3s to the server.

Once all these settings are done, go back to the 'Output' tab and click on the 'Connect' button. The DSP plug-in will start relaying a stream of music to the waiting server.

Now it's time for a test run. Click on the 'Start' button and get your SimpleServer:Shout running. A small window pops up saying: 'Waiting for encoder to connect'. Provided that your DSP plug-in is streaming music properly, anyone can connect to your audio stream and listen to the music that is playing.

Now that you have set up a personal radio station on the Web, give your friends a buzz and ask them to listen in. All they have to do is click on the 'Add' button in their Winamp play list window and choose 'Add URL'. This opens a small text window. Tell them to enter the URL or IP of your server. For example, here your friend can enter <http://203.195.204.45:8000> assuming that '203.195.204.45' is the IP of your streaming server. Double-clicking the entry added in his play list will connect him to the live audio stream from your PC.

Dessert

The really sweet part of having your own server is being able to run a personal Web server. We have something really light and free that is available at [www.analogx.com](http://www.analogx.com). Just download SimpleServer application and click 'Install'. Launch the application from **Start > Programs** menu and you will see a small window with four buttons. The button on top shows the IP (static/dynamic) assigned to the PC on which SimpleServer runs. There are three other buttons at the bottom of the Window. The first button tells you about the creator of the software. The button in the middle lets you select the path from where all your Internet pages will be served through the Web server (this will be a directory in which all your Web pages and images are stored), and the last button lets you start and stop the server. Tasty, isn't it?

Setting it up can also be done in a jiffy. First, store all your Web pages and images in the folder from where the Web server will serve pages to visitors. This is the page your friends and relatives and everyone else will see by typing <http://yourip> in their browser. It's as easy as that.

Before you burp

There you go, your server meal is complete. Hope you enjoyed this experience for you'll be busy in the near future, telling your friends how to set up their own servers! Meanwhile, after dessert, we could've had coffee and cigars while streaming videos to friends, but sadly, all software for these purposes is strictly commercial. There is no such thing as a free meal, you know. But don't lose hope, it will be here one fine day, sooner rather than later. As of now, we hope you enjoyed that nice, fulfilling broadband meal! 

VIDYARAMANAN S.